Shaniah Reece

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EDUCATION

Emory University
Computer Science, PhD; GPA: 3.8/ 4.0 — *May 2023 - Present*

Emory University
Computer Science, Masters; GPA: 3.8/ 4.0 — *Expected: December 2026*

University of Maryland, Baltimore County
Information Systems, B.S.; GPA: 3.6/ 4.0 — *Aug 2019 - May 2023*

SKILLS

Research Methods: Semi-structured interviews, surveys, co-design and participatory design workshops, speculative design, usability testing, thematic and qualitative analysis, literature reviews
Design and Prototyping: Figma, wireframing, storyboarding, prototyping, 3D printing, laser cutting, Arduino
Data Analysis: Python, R, SQL, Tableau
Other Programming: Java, HTML, CSS, PHP, Python, C++
Certifications: CITI Human Subjects Protection, HIPAA@Emory

RESEARCH/ INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

Emory University, CARE Lab — Atlanta, GA
Graduate Research Assistant — *Aug 2024 – Present*

- Designed and facilitated speculative co-design workshops with 3 menopausal women and 4 clinicians to generate interventions for menopause care and education, centering participants from marginalized communities
- Design and facilitate co-design workshops with 4 residents and 4 attending physicians to evaluate the menopause curriculum, surfacing gaps and prioritizing opportunities for improvement
- Synthesized survey and interview data from menopausal participants into key insights that shaped later workshops, bringing patient perspectives to clinicians and residents
- Built a research partnership with an online menopause community of 15,000+ members to understand user needs, community interaction patterns, and opportunities for collaboration
- Conducted a literature review of design methods and frameworks in menopause research, identifying methodological gaps that informed the study approach
- Partnered with an interdisciplinary team of clinicians, public health specialists, and computer scientists to plan and run the study end to end

Emory University, DETOUR Lab — Atlanta, GA
Graduate Research Assistant — *May 2023 – Present*

- Trained 6 researchers in design-thinking, guiding them from initial concept to a user-tested final prototype
- Co-created a pop-up makerspace that expanded access to making and technology for Black women, engaging 10 participants across 7 sessions
- Co-facilitated a co-design workshop where Black women in computing combined craft practice with technology, adapting activities for novice to intermediate skill levels
- Conduct qualitative analysis of interview and workshop transcripts using the Sort & Sift, Think & Shift method to identify themes and insights
- Lead literature reviews and present synthesized findings to guide lab research direction
- Mentor undergraduate research assistants on study design, data collection, and analysis

National Center for Atmospheric Research (NCAR) — Boulder, CO
SIParCS Intern — *May 2022 – Jul 2022*

- Collaborated with mentors to improve COVID-19 forecasts by applying NCAR's Data Assimilation Research Testbed (DART) to an extended SEIR epidemiological model
- Demonstrated the value of ensemble data assimilation on COVID-19 data from 4 countries, improving forecasts despite sparse data and missing parameters

- Tuned the SEIR model using ensemble methods, including the Kalman filter and rank histogram filter, and contributed the code to the project's Git repository
- Presented findings to technical and academic audiences at NCAR, the University at Buffalo conference, and the McNair Conference, explaining how ensemble data improves epidemiological forecasts

Division of Information Technology, UMBC Baltimore, MD
Desktop Student Technician *Jun 2021 – Oct 2021*

- Resolved hardware and software issues for staff in-person and remotely, explaining fixes clearly to non-technical users
- Collaborated with 2 teammates to connect Mac and Windows computers to network printers and update drivers for an event with about 20 guests

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Tactile Map with Multimodal Input for Low-Vision Users *May 2024*
Decision Support System for the Miami International Airport *Dec 2022*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Foundations in HCI, Emory, Atlanta, GA *Jan 2025 – May 2025*
Research Methods in HCI, Emory, Atlanta, GA *Aug 2024 – Dec 2024*
Computing, AI, Ethics, and Society Emory, Atlanta, GA *Aug 2023 – Dec 2023*
Volunteer Summer Tutor, Building Steps Non-Profit, Baltimore, MD *Jul 2021 – Aug 2021*

CONFERENCES / PRESENTATIONS

SIParCS Symposium *Jul 2022*
UMBC McNair Conference *Sept 2022*
Tapia Conference *Sep 2021*

PUBLICATIONS

Shaniah Reece, Nyah Rene, Khloe Wright, Andrina McQuick and Yolanda A. Rankin. 2027. Stitching Resistance: Turning a Makerspace into a Counterspace for Black Women. Proceedings of the 58th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE 2027), Sacramento, CA. (To appear)

Yolanda A. Rankin, Shaniah Reece, Covenant Adenuga, Jakita O. Thomas, Jamika Burge, and Aisha J. Roberts. 2026. Creating Counterspaces for Black Women in Computing. In Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Research on Equity and Sustained Participation in Engineering, Computing, and Technology (RESPECT 2026). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 42–50. https://doi.org/10.1145/3796496.3811775

Shaniah Reece. 2025. Designing the AfroVerse for Black Women in Computing. In Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Research on Equitable and Sustained Participation in Engineering, Computing, and Technology (RESPECT 2025). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 383–384. https://doi.org/10.1145/370

Shaniah Reece, Covenant Adenuga, Tierra Ablorh, and Yolanda Rankin. 2025. "A Powerful Sisterhood: Black Women Scholars in Feminist HCI." ACM Interactions Jan/Feb Issue.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Women in Natural Science Fellowship *May 2023*
Grace Hopper Conference Scholar *May 2022*
Tapia Conference Scholar *May 2021*
Lockheed Martin Scholarship *Aug 2019*

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Secretary, Laney Graduate Student Council, Emory, Atlanta, GA *May 2024 – June 2025*
Computer Science Ambassador, Emory, Atlanta, GA *Aug 2024 - June 2025*
Lead Resident Assistant, Residential Life, UMBC, Baltimore, MD *May 2022 – May 2023*
President, CWIT Student Council *May 2022 – May 2023*